

Challenge Name: secrets in the shadows - 100 (WEB)

Challenge Info



Description

[Instance](#)

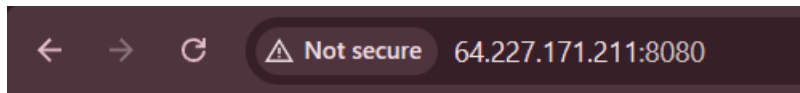
You've stumbled upon a legacy web application that's been left exposed to the wild. The developers were careless, leaving Temporary Files and files with flag scattered across the system.

OS : Linux Version: 6.12.43+deb13-amd64

Flag 

The Setup

When visited on the URL. The web app shows a simple file-search page:



Welcome Message

A Lazy Fox Jump Over the Bus

Welcome to the Internal

hacked by @yelan

Search Your Files !

Page to include:

When performing searches the URL changed to something like:

- <http://64.227.171.211:8080/?page=ls>

That **page** parameter looked like a classic LFI/vector to try path traversal.

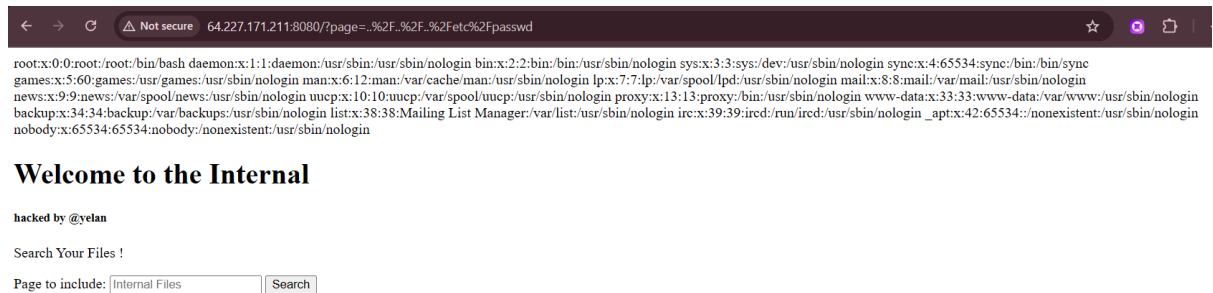
Recon & Initial Test

To test for LFI, I tried a basic traversal payload to include a well-known system file:

- `?page=../../etc/passwd`

URL used:

- <http://64.227.171.211:8080/?page=..%2F..%2F..%2Fetc%2Fpasswd>



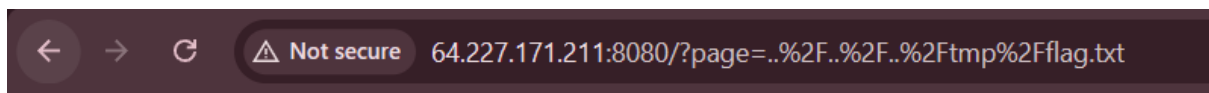
The server returned the contents of `/etc/passwd`, confirming a Local File Inclusion / path traversal vulnerability.

Exploitation — Finding the Flag

The challenge description hinted that developers left **temporary files** and **files with the flag** scattered across the system. A standard temp location on Linux is `/tmp`. I attempted to read the flag file:



This returned the flag in clear text:



SPL{e3550d74a7a981d5f18be938692898df}

Welcome to the Internal

hacked by @yelan

Search Your Files !

Page to include:

Flag captured.

Why it worked

The application directly used the page parameter to include or read files from disk without validating or sanitizing it. By allowing `../` traversal, an attacker can escape intended directories and read arbitrary files readable by the web server process — including temporaries, config files, and any file that contains secrets.

Final

- Nice and classic LFI challenge — simple, educational, and a reminder that path traversal is still a common oversight.
- **Flag:** SPL{e3550d74a7a981d5f18be938692898df}

~By: 1nf1n1ty